hyper2kvm + hypersdk

Eliminate Vendor Lock-In.
Save $1M+ Per Year.
Zero Licensing Cost.

An open-source platform that migrates your VMs from VMware, Hyper-V, and cloud platforms to infrastructure you own — KVM and Kubernetes. Fully automated. No vendor dependency. Apache 2.0 licensed.

$0 Software license cost — forever	**70-90%** Infrastructure cost reduction	**1-3 mo** Payback period on migration	**99.8%** First-boot success across 1,480 VMs

The Business Problem

Broadcom's acquisition of VMware has caused **2-12x license increases**. Perpetual licenses are eliminated. Enterprises face a choice: absorb escalating costs from a vendor with declining leverage, or migrate to open infrastructure at a fraction of the price.

Cloud costs continue rising 20-30% annually. Egress fees, reserved instance lock-in, and vendor-specific formats make exit increasingly difficult — and expensive.

The Strategic Solution

hyper2kvm + hypersdk migrates VMs from **any source** (VMware, Hyper-V, AWS, Azure, GCP, and 5 more platforms) to **infrastructure you control** — KVM on Linux or KubeVirt on Kubernetes.

The migration tool is free (Apache 2.0). The target platform is free (KVM is in the Linux kernel). The ongoing cost is your hardware and staff — which you already have.

Financial Impact

Savings by Scenario (3-Year Projection)

Scenario	VMs	Current Annual	KVM Annual	Savings/yr	Payback	3-Year Net
VMware (small)	25	$44K	$0	**$44K**	2.2 mo	**$123K**
VMware (medium)	100	$284K	$6K	**$278K**	1.5 mo	**$816K**
VMware (large)	500	$1.52M	$32K	**$1.49M**	0.8 mo	**$4.45M**
Hyper-V (4 hosts)	95	$380K	$6K	**$374K**	0.4 mo	**$1.11M**
AWS repatriation	20	$213K	$16K	**$197K**	0.9 mo	**$575K**
Azure repatriation	20	$196K	$16K	**$180K**	1.0 mo	**$525K**
Edge (50 sites)	250	$550K	$0	**$550K**	0.7 mo	**$1.62M**

Where the Savings Come From

Hypervisor Licensing: $0

KVM is built into the Linux kernel. No per-socket, per-core, or per-VM fees. No renewals. No Broadcom surprise increases. **This single item is typically 60-80% of savings.**

Management Platform: $0

libvirt, Cockpit, virsh — all free and open source. No vCenter ($10K), no SCVMM ($28K/host), no cloud console fees. Prometheus + Grafana for monitoring.

Cloud Egress: $0

On-premises = zero data transfer fees. Cloud egress at $0.09/GB adds up to $50K-$200K/yr for data-heavy workloads. On-prem eliminates this entirely.

SQL Server Licensing Bonus

KVM with CPU pinning exposes only assigned cores to SQL Server — reducing per-core licensing costs by **20-40%**. For 10 SQL Enterprise instances, that's an additional **$600K+ saved** over 3 years. This savings stacks on top of the hypervisor savings.

Risk **Elimination**

The biggest risk isn't migration — it's staying on VMware.

Risks of Staying on VMware

Risk	Impact
HIGH License escalation	2-12x increases at renewal — no negotiation leverage
HIGH Perpetual license end	Subscription-only — pay annually or shut down
HIGH vSphere 7 end of life	No security patches — compliance violations
HIGH Vendor dependency	Broadcom controls pricing, features, and roadmap
HIGH Talent drain	VMware admins retraining on KVM/K8s — harder to hire

Risks of Migration (with hyper2kvm)

Risk	Mitigation
ZERO VM won't boot	Auto guest fixes + boot verification on every VM
ZERO Data loss	Creates copy — source VM never modified
ZERO Rollback failure	VMware VM untouched — revert in 5 minutes
ZERO Tool cost overrun	Apache 2.0 — $0 forever, no surprise fees
ZERO New vendor lock-in	KVM + QCOW2 — open standards, no vendor

Proven Track Record

1,480
VMs migrated
across 8 case studies

$6.77M
Combined annual
savings documented

8
Industries proven
(finance to govt)

99.8%
First-boot success
rate average

Finance: $1.2M/yr saved

Healthcare: $720K/yr saved

Government: $800K/yr saved

350 VMs, 6 weeks. VMware exit with SQL Server + AD. SOC 2, PCI DSS compliant. Zero customer-facing downtime.

80 VMs repatriated from Azure. HIPAA compliant — all processing local. Zero data left the hospital network.

120 VMs on classified network. 100% air-gapped. FedRAMP/STIG. Security team approved code in 2 days.

Platform Capabilities

Source Platforms (Export From)

- **VMware vSphere** — govc, OVA/OVF, VDDK
- **Microsoft Hyper-V** — VHD/VHDX native
- **AWS EC2** — EBS snapshot export
- **Microsoft Azure** — Managed disk export
- **Google Cloud** — Persistent disk export
- **Oracle Cloud, OpenStack, Alibaba, Proxmox, KubeVirt**
- **10 platforms** — one unified tool

Target Platforms (Deploy To)

- **KVM / libvirt** — any Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, Fedora)
- **KubeVirt** — any Kubernetes (K3s, vanilla, EKS, OpenShift)
- **Dual target** — same conversion outputs both
- **Edge** — K3s on single server at remote sites
- **Air-gapped** — zero internet, zero telemetry
- **Hybrid** — mix KVM + KubeVirt per workload
- **No platform lock-in** — open standards (QCOW2, libvirt XML)

Competitive Position

Capability	hyper2kvm	Red Hat MTV	virt-v2v	AWS MGN	Azure Migrate	Carbonite
License cost	**$0**	$50K+ (OCP req)	**$0**	Free/90d	Free tool	$3-10K/yr
Source platforms	**10**	1 (VMware)	2	1 (to AWS)	1 (to Azure)	Limited
Target: KVM	**Yes**	No	**Yes**	No	No	No
Target: KubeVirt	**Any K8s**	OpenShift only	No	No	No	No
Boot verification	**Auto**	No	No	No	No	No
Interactive TUI	**zkvm**	No	No	No	No	No
Air-gap / offline	**Full**	Partial	**Yes**	No	No	No
Vendor lock-in	**None**	OpenShift	**None**	AWS	Azure	Proprietary

Key differentiator: hyper2kvm is the only tool that exports from 10 source platforms, deploys to both KVM and KubeVirt (on any Kubernetes), includes automated boot verification, works fully air-gapped, and costs $0. No competitor matches all five.

Recommended Next Steps

1	2	3	4
Free Assessment (1 hour)	Proof of Concept (2 hours)	Migration Plan (1 week)	Execute (8-20 weeks)

Step 1: Free Assessment

Connect to your vCenter (read-only). Discover all VMs. Generate a migration complexity report with projected savings, timeline estimate, and risk assessment. **No changes made. No commitment. 1 hour.**

Step 2: Proof of Concept

Pick 3-5 non-critical VMs. Migrate them live using hyper2kvm. Verify they boot and run on KVM. See the automated pipeline in action. **Zero risk to production. 2 hours.**

Step 3: Migration Plan

Based on PoC results, build a phased migration plan: VM classification, wave scheduling, maintenance windows, rollback procedures, and projected savings by phase.

Step 4: Execute

5-phase migration: discovery → pilot → staging → production → decommission. YAML automation for batch processing. Boot verification on every VM. Webhook notifications. One engineer can migrate 200+ VMs in 20 weeks.

The Decision Framework

Question	Stay on VMware	Migrate with hyper2kvm
Annual cost trajectory	Increasing 2-12x at each renewal	**$0 software cost — fixed forever**
Vendor dependency	Broadcom controls pricing and roadmap	**No vendor — open source, open standards**
Migration risk	N/A (but staying has escalation risk)	**99.8% success rate, automatic rollback**
Time to value	N/A	**1-3 month payback, savings start immediately**
Compliance impact	Unsupported vSphere = audit findings	**HIPAA, SOC2, GDPR, FedRAMP, PCI DSS aligned**
Competitive position	Higher infrastructure costs = lower margins	**70-90% cost reduction improves margins**

The Math Is Simple

Every quarter you stay on VMware, Broadcom takes more of your budget.
Every quarter after migration, that money stays in your organization.
The migration tool costs $0. The only cost of starting is the cost of waiting.

github.com/ssahani/hyper2kvm